regarding optimization of the healthy use of screen time.

As things started moving back to normal, the social structures started to bounce back to the so-called "previous normal". However, it soon became apparent that the use of internet and social media network have created unnecessary reliance on screen time and started to negatively impacts on different social spheres.

> Ms. Talari has brought to our attention the significance of keeping an effective balance regarding optimal use of screen time in the post-covid era.

It is being increasingly recognized that both the modern generation and adult/elderly have impact on spiritual and mental wellbeing from excessive use of social media. Technology has become more portable and personalized. Psychological tricks have been used to increase adherence to these online products, displacing physical activities and interpersonal mixing. Yamini Talari has rightly pointed out that these led to rewiring of childhood in an unprecedented way and hugely impacted human development. User generated videos and streamed entertainments kept people "online" but creating barriers in such simple acts like making eye contact when talking with an individual in person. Yamini points out that these acts are as much brain damaging like gambling. She further pointed out that with an expanding virtual world, there are no regulations of the exposed contents.

- **What is the scope of the problem?**
  During the pandemic, the only way to engage with the community and keep an active social network was the use of internet and different forums. However, once the societal regulations were loosening, individuals had difficulty giving up their early habits of excessive usage of the internet. Not only did this have an impact on sleep cycle, but it also led to a development of withdrawal-like phenomena. 'The work from home culture', though tremendously helpful during pandemic times, created a disruptive trajectory in a more traditional disciplined daily time scale. Recent studies are actually showing that this can be associated with lower quality of mental health.
- **Is there any particular group that is affected?**
  Younger people less than 40 years of age use social media more, thus these age groups got affected the most. People's behavior relied on using the social media to new and unknown contacts, creating a separate avenue of challenges. The intrapersonal motives varied widely, but to cope the complications of daily life and to simply pass time reflected problematic angle of usage of social media.
- **Did it result in any frank health condition?**
  Sure, it impacted both physical and mental health. It created depression and anxiety, sleep disturbances and aggravation of chronic medical conditions like high blood pressure.
- **What impact did it have on school going children?**
  This is the age group with which I am particularly concerned. Formal studies are showing that excessive screen time is causing severe impact on learning skills. Not only this will have impact on school grades, it has important negative connotation on attention span, metacognition, and has raised challenges of development of high risk behavior.
- **What exactly do you mean by that?**
  Preliminary studies are showing a steep rise in use of alcohol, marijuana and tobacco, especially among adolescent populations across the globe. This is highly concerning and a very scary public health problem.
- **Is there any gender-based difference in the impact?**
  There is equal impact on all populations.
- **What potential solutions have you been looking at?**
  I have been advocating community engagement. Personal interactions and frequent in-person meetings are one of the first steps in addressing this massive global problem. It has to be emphasized at every level that human relationships are very valued. Though it is undeniable regarding the role of computers and information systems in the modern world, we must emphasize that technology is only a means to achieve good for humanity. As Jacob Bronowski had emphasized, the purpose of science is to humanize people, and rather than the reverse. Nudging audit should be done at every level to preserve the intangible but beautiful interpersonal relationship.
- **How do you suggest to increase the human connect?**
  Simply by caring to say "hello". Just like the industrial revolution, which turned science from mere stargazing to its modern interest in the use of electromechanical power, the worldwide web has metamorphosed modern humanity. However, its central players still remain the human beings. That notion and insight should never be lost. Practising simple measures like getting together, vacations, picnics, hygge and even brief phone calls will gradually again set back the tune for appreciating mankind as the major force of humanity. This will have a strong positive impact on overall behavioral and physical health of individuals across the globe, while still making useful utilization of a digitally connected shrunken world.
- **What is your final advice?**
  Social media has created an illusion of connection. Everyone is striving to lead a varied, competitive, two-dimensional, "Insta" life. There is help available, simple acts like dinnertime together, returning to the playground, soccer and hockey nights, book clubs, which will reinforce face to face relationships. Additionally, professional help should be actively sought if someone is facing a crisis.

> While we should continue to reap the benefits of global connectivity through the internet, establishing healthy personal relationships will help enable create high class humanity and face up to any challenges of the future.

Instead of limitless way to entertain ourselves from the comfort of the digital living room it is aright step to regularly and periodically hang around with friends. I remain optimistic of continued growth of communities with these simple concepts.